

Before You Launch Your Website

What to check before you announce your site to customers. No coding needed: each item tells you how to check it yourself.

1 Domain and security

If the browser labels your site "Not secure", many visitors leave before reading anything.

- ☐ **The padlock shows next to the address on every page**
Open your site in Chrome and on your phone, and check several pages, not just the home page.
- ☐ **The http:// version sends you to https:// on its own**
Type `http://yourdomain.com` in the browser and see where you end up.
- ☐ **With and without www you land on the same site**
Try `www.yourdomain.com` and `yourdomain.com`.
- ☐ **The domain is registered in your name, with auto-renew on**
Ask for access to the registrar account (GoDaddy, Namecheap, etc.). If only your developer has it, the domain isn't really yours.

3 Mobile and speed

Most of your visitors arrive on a phone.

- ☐ **Text is readable without zooming and nothing runs off the screen**
Go through the whole site on your own phone, held upright.
- ☐ **Buttons are easy to tap with a finger**
If you have to aim carefully, they're too small or too close together.
- ☐ **Pages load in a few seconds on mobile data**
Turn off Wi-Fi and open it. Then run your address through `pagespeed.web.dev` and check the mobile result.
- ☐ **Photos are lightweight**
A 5 MB phone photo should be compressed before it goes on the site.

2 Forms and contact

A form that doesn't deliver is a customer you lose without ever knowing.

- ☐ **Every form delivers to the right inbox**
Send a test from each form. Check the spam folder too.
- ☐ **The phone number and WhatsApp button open the app on a phone**
Tap them on your phone, not on a computer.
- ☐ **Address, hours and phone match your Google listing**
Compare the contact page with your Google Maps profile.
- ☐ **A way to contact you is visible on every page**
Usually in the menu or the footer.

4 Content

Small mistakes make a serious business look careless.

- ☐ **No placeholder text ("Lorem ipsum") or stock sample photos remain**
Look on every page for text you didn't write.
- ☐ **Prices, services and promotions are current**
Review them with someone who talks to customers every day.
- ☐ **Every link goes where it says**
Click every button and every link in the menu and footer.
- ☐ **There's a 404 error page with a link back**
Type `yourdomain.com/test-123` and see what shows up.
- ☐ **There's a privacy policy if the site collects names or emails**
Link it from the footer and next to your forms.

5 Google

If Google doesn't know your site, your customers won't find it by searching.

- ☐ **Each page has its own title and description**
That's the text shown in search results. Ask your developer what each page's is.
- ☐ **The site is registered in Google Search Console**
It's free. You submit the sitemap there and Google tells you about errors.
- ☐ **Your Google Business Profile links to the new site**
Check it at business.google.com.
- ☐ **A visitor analytics tool is installed**
Google Analytics or another. Without it you won't know if the site brings customers.
- ☐ **The site shows up on Google**
A few days after launch, search `site:yourdomain.com`

6 After launch

A website is like a storefront: it needs upkeep even when nobody's looking.

- ☐ **Backups run automatically and someone has tested a restore**
A backup nobody tested may fail the day you need it.
- ☐ **You have every login written down**
Domain, hosting, email, WordPress and social accounts. Keep them somewhere safe, in your name.
- ☐ **It's clear who updates the site and how often**
On WordPress, outdated plugins are the most common way attackers get in.
- ☐ **You get an alert if the site goes down**
UptimeRobot has a free plan that emails you.
- ☐ **You know when the domain and hosting expire**
Put the dates on your calendar, even with auto-renew on.

7 Your access sheet

Fill it in on launch day and keep it. Don't write passwords here: those belong in a password manager like Bitwarden or 1Password.

SERVICE	COMPANY	LOGIN USERNAME OR EMAIL	EXPIRES OR RENEWS
Domain			
Hosting			
Business email			
Site dashboard (WordPress or other)			
Google Search Console			
Google Business Profile			
Google Analytics			
Backups			

Any boxes left unchecked?

I'll go through your site with you, tell you what's missing and what it costs to fix, no strings attached. I also build new sites for businesses.

WhatsApp **+1 (725) 600-1802**
github.com/gleimbek